

1933

ADOLF HITLER APPOINTED GERMAN CHANCELLOR

Promising to restore national pride to Germany, the National Socialists (Nazis), led by Adolf Hitler, won seats in government, and Hitler was appointed chancellor. Soon after, the Reichstag building burned down. Blaming Communists, Hitler declared an emergency and imposed a one-party dictatorship.

Fuelled by a belief in a pure Aryan race, the Nazis boycotted Jewish businesses, publicly burned books considered “un-German”, and violently crushed opposition.

▷ Adolf Hitler is greeted by crowds of supporters



1932 The Chaco War,
a territorial dispute,
breaks out between
Bolivia and Paraguay

**1933 Spanish anarcho-
syndicalists** rise up in
Madrid, protesting poor
living conditions

1933 Franklin D. Roosevelt,
the newly elected US president,
introduces his New Deal
economic relief programme

1934



△ The “Dust Bowl” – the drought-stricken US Midwest

1932

GREAT DEPRESSION INTENSIFIES

By the early 1930s, economic depression had spread worldwide. In the US some 15 million people were out of work and in Germany the figure was about 5 million. Poverty was widespread, soup kitchens were commonplace, and in the US the lack of state welfare meant thousands became homeless. A series of droughts and dust storms in the Midwest drove farmers off their lands, exacerbating the problem.

1934

MAO LEADS THE LONG MARCH

Following attempts by the Kuomintang (the Chinese National Party) to dislodge

Chinese Communists from Jiangxi province, Mao Zedong led the Red Army out of the province westwards, hoping to find a safe base. About 100,000 people marched 9,700km (6,027 miles) to Shaanxi province, where Mao set up a Communist base. Only about 7,000 troops of the original force reached Yan'an.



△ The Long March